

Where Is the Shape? Position Words on a Shelf

Answer Key

Kindergarten–Grade 1

Quick Answers

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|------|------------|------|---------------|
| 1. — | 3. — | 5. — | 7. 4, 3, 2, 1 |
| 2. — | 4. 1, 2, 3 | 6. — | 8. —, — |
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Curriculum

Level: Kindergarten–Grade 1

K.G / 1.G – *problems 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8*

Difficulty 1–4 of 5 across 9 tagged checks.

The scene, in words. Shelf 3 (top): circle in spot 1, triangle in spot 3. Shelf 2 (middle): square in spot 2, hexagon in spot 4. Shelf 1 (bottom): rectangle in spot 1, oval in spot 2, diamond in spot 4. Bigger shelf number means higher up; bigger spot number means farther right.

1. Circle (shelf 3) compared with square (shelf 2).

Find both shapes on the picture first. The circle sits on the top shelf and the square on the middle shelf. The shelf numbers are 3 and 2, and 3 is the larger number, so write the greater-than sign between them.

$$3 > 2$$

Because the circle's shelf number is bigger, the circle is higher up. **The circle is ABOVE the square.**

Say it with the child: “Three is more than two, so the circle is higher.”

2. Rectangle (spot 1) compared with diamond (spot 4).

Both shapes are on the bottom shelf, so height does not decide this one — the spot numbers do. Spot 1 is at the far left and spot 4 is at the far right, and 1 is the smaller number.

$$1 < 4$$

A smaller spot number means farther left. **The rectangle is to the LEFT of the diamond.**

3. Oval (shelf 1) compared with hexagon (shelf 2).

The oval is on the bottom shelf and the hexagon on the middle shelf. Compare the shelf numbers in the order the question asks: 1 first, then 2. Since 1 is smaller, the less-than sign goes between them.

$$1 < 2$$

A smaller shelf number means lower down. **The oval is BELOW the hexagon.**

Watch for: a child who answers “above” because the oval is written first in the sentence. Have them point at the two shapes before choosing.

4. Order three shelf numbers from bottom to top.

The three given numbers are 2 (hexagon), 3 (triangle), and 1 (rectangle). “Bottom to top” means smallest shelf number first, so put them in counting order. 1, 2, 3

Reading that order back to the shapes: the rectangle is on shelf 1, the hexagon on shelf 2, the triangle on shelf 3.

Lowest: the rectangle. Highest: the triangle.

5. Hexagon (spot 4) compared with square (spot 2).

Both shapes are on the middle shelf, so again the spot numbers decide. The question asks for 4 first, then 2, and 4 is the larger number. 4 > 2

A bigger spot number means farther right. **The hexagon is to the RIGHT of the square.**

6. Draw a triangle between the square and the hexagon, then say where it is.
(Open response — flagged for manual review.)

Model answer. The square is in spot 2 of the middle shelf and the hexagon is in spot 4, so the empty place between them is spot 3. A triangle drawn there sits with a spot number bigger than the square’s and smaller than the hexagon’s.

The sentence can be finished correctly in several ways: *to the right of, beside, next to*. All three are true of a triangle in spot 3, and all three earn full credit.

The extra sentence with *between* should say something like: “My triangle is between the square and the hexagon,” or “It is between spot 2 and spot 4.”

Grading note: accept any position word that is true of the drawing the child actually made. Do not accept “above” or “below” — all three shapes share the middle shelf, so no vertical word applies. If the triangle was drawn on the wrong shelf, grade the sentence against where it really is, and then re-read the question together.

7. Order four spot numbers from right to left.

The four given numbers are 2 (square), 4 (diamond), 1 (circle), and 3 (triangle). “Right to left” means starting from the biggest spot number and counting down. 4, 3, 2, 1

Reading that order back to the shapes: diamond, triangle, square, circle.

Farthest right: the diamond.

Watch for: a child who writes 1, 2, 3, 4 out of counting habit. Ask which shape is farthest right, and let them start there.

8. Triangle (shelf 3, spot 3) compared with oval (shelf 1, spot 2) — two position words.

(a) Compare the shelf numbers first, in the order asked: 3 then 1. The triangle’s shelf number is bigger. 3 > 1

The triangle is ABOVE the oval.

(b) Now compare the spot numbers, again in the order asked: 3 then 2. The triangle’s spot number is bigger. 3 > 2

The triangle is to the RIGHT of the oval.

Why this one is harder: the two shapes share neither a shelf nor a spot, so one word is not enough to say where the triangle is. Together the two words locate it exactly: above and to the right.